

‘There is no better place than the place where the shot heard ’round the world was fired.’

STEVE KERRIGAN, *chair of the state Democratic Party*

Mass. Democrats optimistic on convention

Boston, one of 5 finalists for 2028, called rejuvenated

By **Samantha J. Gross** and **Kelly Garrity**

GLOBE STAFF

As Democrats nationally map an ever-evolving strategy to counter President Trump, the party in Massachusetts is trying

to frame its home city as a seat of historic resistance — a message it hopes will help persuade the Democratic National Committee to name Boston as host of the party’s national convention in 2028.

Plus, Democratic boosters here say, Boston is a rejuvenated city, with a brand-new waterfront neighborhood and twice the hotel capacity it had the last time it hosted thousands of

Democratic delegates in 2004.

“There is no better place than the place where the shot heard ’round the world was fired, where our democracy began,” said Steve Kerrigan, chair of the state Democratic Party and leader of the bid to host the 2028 convention. “Where many people in the nation are pushing back against the autocracy in the White House, where better to go than the place that

gave birth to it all?”

The DNC reached out to dozens of major cities last summer, party officials said, and on Monday, it named five — Boston, Atlanta, Chicago, Denver, and Philadelphia — as finalists. It isn’t immediately clear when the Democrats will settle on which city will host the convention, set to unfold Aug. 7-10, 2028.

DNC, Page A6

No home for Gen Z

Barely scraping by, they’re thinking twice about trying to make a life here



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

By **Shannon Larson**

GLOBE STAFF

Eye-popping rents for small quarters. Grocery costs that seem to tick up each week. A tough job market for new college grads, and, for those lucky enough to get hired, salaries that barely allow them to scrape by.

There’s no question that Gen Zers in the Boston area are facing major financial headwinds. Boston racked up the second-highest cost of living in the country in 2024, according to Forbes. And the gap between who can afford to stay and who can’t is growing.

Massachusetts consistently ranks among the top five states for domestic outmigration, with experts attributing the exodus to high housing costs, taxes, and health care expenses. According to a 2024 survey from the Greater Boston Chamber of Commerce Foundation, one in four residents ages 20 to 30 say they plan to leave Greater Boston within the next several years.

Many who choose to stay are living lean. The Globe spoke with sev-

JOSIE GOLDER’S MONTHLY EXPENSES

Rent	\$1,950
Utilities	\$100
Food*	\$450
Transportation	\$60
Entertainment*	\$440
Student loans	\$1,000

Monthly total \$4,000

*Food includes coffee, drinks, and going out to eat. Entertainment includes shopping, travel fund, and workout classes.

JOHN HANCOCK/GLOBE STAFF

Josie Golder is squeezed into a 200-square-foot attic on Beacon Hill. It’s got other problems, too.

eral twentysomethings to better understand how they are managing high costs. Some said they have grown accustomed to skipping meals, or putting off medical appointments. Others track their expenses with the precision of accountants, and still come up short.

Here are a few of their stories.

Josie Golder

26, a lawyer who lives in Beacon Hill

‘I take everything day by day’

Josie Golder lives in a 200-square-foot attic on Beacon Hill. The heat is spotty, the ceiling slanted. Located directly above an empty storefront, the space has just enough room to squeeze a full-sized bed in and little else.

When Golder graduated from law school at Northeastern University last spring, many of her peers flocked to cushy jobs at corporate firms, where they’re making around \$200,000 a year, she said. She chose a less lucrative path — working for the city in employment and labor

GEN Z, Page B4

Trump says potential new leaders dead

Uncertain about a Khamenei successor

By **Jim Tankersley**, **Aaron Boxerman**, **Christina Goldbaum**, and **Michael Levenson**

NEW YORK TIMES

As the war in the Middle East expands, President Trump on Tuesday acknowledged the deep uncertainty about what comes next in Iran, saying that officials the United States had eyed as potential new leaders had been killed in the US-Israeli bombing campaign.

“Most of the people we had in mind are dead,” Trump said at the start of a White House meeting with Chancellor Friedrich Merz of Germany. He said it was possible that whoever takes over Iran could be “as

bad” as Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, the country’s supreme leader, who was killed in a strike on Saturday.

Trump’s comments came as Israeli troops seized more areas in southern Lebanon and called for the evacuation of at least 80 Lebanese villages. The Israeli military cast the move as an effort to defend Israeli border towns against rockets fired by Hezbollah, the militia backed by Iran.

Israeli warplanes also carried out heavy airstrikes near Beirut, the Lebanese capital, and Tehran, the Iranian capital.

The United States closed embassies that were hit by drones

IRAN, Page A4



AMIRHOSSEIN KHORGOOEI/ISNA/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

A funeral of three children killed in a strike was held Tuesday.

Tech addicts finding community in real life

By **Marin Wolf**

GLOBE STAFF

They gathered one recent evening in a drafty storage room in a Cambridge church, seated in a circle. A petite 25-year-old woman in a plaid dress cleared her throat.

“I’m Christine and I’m an internet and technology addict,” she said.

“Hi, Christine,” seven voices echoed in unison.

Christine’s screen addiction intensified in college. She would watch comedy clips on YouTube for hours on end in her dorm room instead of studying or hanging out with friends. She wouldn’t eat, wouldn’t sleep, wouldn’t take breaks to go to the bathroom. She pushed herself to the verge of getting physically ill. Even when the dopamine rush of starting a new video wore off, when she wasn’t having fun anymore, she couldn’t stop. The next morning, her eyes would burn and her head would ache, but the worst part was the self-loathing and fear that she couldn’t change.

“My life was really not very functional,” said Christine, now

ADDICTION, Page A7

Public high school students in Massachusetts last year had the best AP scores ever recorded but some of the tests have gotten easier. **B1.**

Representative Stephen Lynch said he’s “100 percent” for the Foxborough Select Board as it threatens to withhold the entertainment license needed for FIFA to stage World Cup games at Gillette Stadium. **C1.**

Boston police officers once again dominated the list of the highest-paid city workers in 2025, with overtime driving take-home pay. **B1.**

Point32Health is facing red ink again as it struggles with the high cost of weight loss drugs. **B5.**



A gem in the North End

Little Sage is everything you want a restaurant in that neighborhood to be, writes Devra First. Above, fazzoletti from the brick oven. **G1.**

More seasoning

Wednesday: Much warmer. High 49-54. Low 29-34.

Thursday: More rain. High 39-44. Low 31-36.

Sunrise: 6:15 Sunset: 5:37

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



Obsessing over every unhealthy bite has to get old — or does it?

BETH TEITELL

All around me, people were desperately trying to hit their wellness goals — stuffing themselves with protein and fiber, staggering under weighted vests, obsessing over their heart rate variability — when in the middle of it all, my phone rang.

It was my dad — a 93-year-old lawyer who’s still working, a former marathoner and ultramarathoner, who marked his latest birthday by walking 9.3 miles, a man who loves a gimmick.

Once — for 30 years — he gave up dessert (with the exception of a few cheat days with a nun, a professional acquaintance, but that’s a different story).

But now, as he waited for my mother in the cafeteria of a medical building, he’d ordered a bagel with full-fat cream cheese. At home, a slice of cheesecake was waiting.

“I’m on a new diet,” he said with his customary good cheer. “The ‘What the Hell’ diet.”

No diet has ever sounded better. But was I old enough to start it?

When you’ve been a reporter for a long time and you cold-call the Society of Actuaries and ask if anyone there might be up for pondering the mortality implications of such a regimen, you don’t expect much.

But here was Nate Worrell, a fellow with the society.

DIET, Page A7



ALLY RZESA/GLOBE STAFF